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Graduate Recruitment Team

LGT Capital Partners

Schützenstrasse 6

8808 Pfäffikon SZ, Switzerland

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Private Equity Analyst Program in Pfäffikon or London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. LGT Capital Partners' secondaries team closed more than \$1.5 billion of transactions in the first half of 2026, acquiring stakes in over 1,400 underlying companies, which is the kind of portfolio-level analysis I want to learn.

My preparation for investing has come from taking deals apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down why the buyer wanted the asset, how the deal was structured and how the stake was valued. My strongest academic results reflect the same interest: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Private equity appeals to me because the investor owns the outcome: the thesis has to be delivered after the deal closes, not just argued before it. I have seen that side at a small scale. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, I created its house cocktails, set the specifications for its classics and trained around 15 bar staff to deliver them from launch. Before that, at KONG, I analysed sales patterns and refined our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. Both roles taught me that value is created in execution: in standards, training and small commercial decisions that compound.

LGT Capital Partners stands out to me because its two-year analyst programme gives graduates real responsibility across secondaries, co-investments and direct investments within a firm managing more than \$110 billion, starting with three weeks of tailored training. Valuing a secondary stake means judging hundreds of underlying companies at once, and my CAPM study of 704 portfolios has taught me to work systematically across large, messy datasets without losing sight of what drives each return.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan